

Microbes in your cell

Exxon Mobil said Wednesday it opened a greenhouse facility to grow and test algae, the next step for its nascent bio-fuels program

Nokia's magical Kinetic concept

Kinetic from Nokia responds to notifications through movements e.g. By standing up

Bazaar

Siemens Gigaset S880

Cordless comes with a price

Siemens Gigaset S880 is a cordless phone with some improved features over previous versions. Siemens Gigaset S880 acts as a base station that can register up to 4 Gigaset S88H handsets.

It is lighter when compared to the previous generation of cordless phones. The charger provided is also light, but doesn't stick to the base and has a propensity to fall off. We found that the handset could easily fall off if not taken care of. The keypad is similar to the basic cellphone keypad, but keys don't give a better grip and the keypad often wobbles. The screen is good for small utilities. The black finish adds to the looks. The clip provided

at the back is good for fixing the handset.

This phone has features like contact list, free internal calls between two handsets and registration of multiple handsets within single base station and directory transfer between two handsets. Features like alarm clock and multiple language support are also present.

For calls, voice clarity on the receiver side is good, but the ear phone sound quality is poor. Calls drop when you change floors. Also the network reception is poor. This phone should have provided more features such as messaging, and also provision for games. Sound quality needs to be improved. Build quality



Specifications

Frequency : 2.4 Ghz; 150 entries phone directory

Contact

Gigaset Communications India
Phone: +91-22- 4003 6435
E-mail: arvind.prasad.ext@gigaset.com
Web site: www.gigaset.com
Price: ₹6,400

5/10

Features:.....6
Performance:.....7
Build quality:.....5.5
Value for money:.....4.5

is also poor. At Rs.6,400 this set is really not a value-for-money product. There are no impressive features bundled with this phone. One can get a better cordless phone at this price with more features.

ASUS ROG Rampage III Extreme

An enthusiast's object of pride

Specifications

Chipset : Intel X58 (NB)
- ICH10R (SB); 2 USB 3.0 ports; dual BIOS chips; 6 Gbps x 2 SATA ports; 4 PCIe x16 slots; LGA 1366 socket

Contact

ASUS Technology Pvt Ltd.
Phone: 1800 209 0365
Email: reachus@asus.com
Website: www.asus.in
Price: ₹30,650

6.5/10

Features:.....8
Performance:.....7
Build Quality:.....7
Value for money:.....4

Asus's ROG series motherboards are choc-a-bloc with features and Rampage III Extreme does not disappoint. Rampage III Extreme is an Intel X58 board. One has to be very careful around the intricate heatsink as it tends to heat a lot and the design has lots of sharp edges. It supports USB 3.0. An interesting addition is the four switches placed adjacent to the Start and Reset buttons, for the disabling/enabling the PCI express x16 slots. It comes

with certain features like ROG Connect, Bluetooth remote control and TurboV. ROG connect allows you to connect your board to another system via USB for overclocking and monitoring. We tested the system using a Core i7 965 processor, Corsair 4 GB DDR3 RAM and a Sparkle GTX 285 graphics card. It gave impressive PC Mark Vantage score of 9234 marks. In video encoding it took a mere 24 secs to convert a 100 MB VOB file to DivX. Trans-



ferring a 4 GB file took around 90 seconds. STALKER : Clear Sky gave a frame rate of 94 fps (1280x1024, low) and Crysis scored 54 fps (1280x1024, High).

A steep pricing of ₹30,650 ensures that this motherboard is meant for enthusiast gamers and overclockers.